

L2 - 11.5. Trooper

Use CTI skills to reconstruct the campaign and unmask the hidden threat actor.

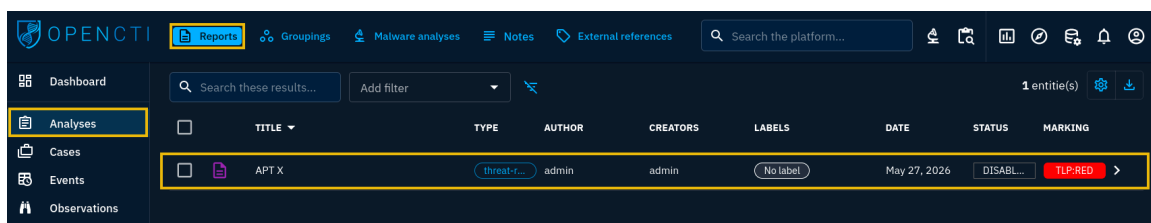
Task - Unmasking APT X : A multinational technology company has been the target of several cyberattacks over the past few months. The attackers have successfully stolen sensitive intellectual property and disrupted the company's operations. A threat advisory report about similar attacks has been shared, and as a CTI analyst, your task is to identify the tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs) being used by the threat group and gather as much information as possible about their identity and motive. For this task, you will utilize the OpenCTI platform to conduct your research.

Lab Access: Click the Start Machine button below. Please give OpenCTI up to five minutes to start and access the dashboard with the following link and credentials: https://LAB_WEB_URL.p.thmlabs.com/ (opens in new tab).

admin@opencti.thm

TryHackMe!

Investigation: Begin your investigation by navigating to the **Analyses** section to open the **APT X** report. Use the provided evidence to extract TTPs and begin mapping the adversary's behavior, then pivot to data in your OpenCTI instance to finalize your threat actor profile.

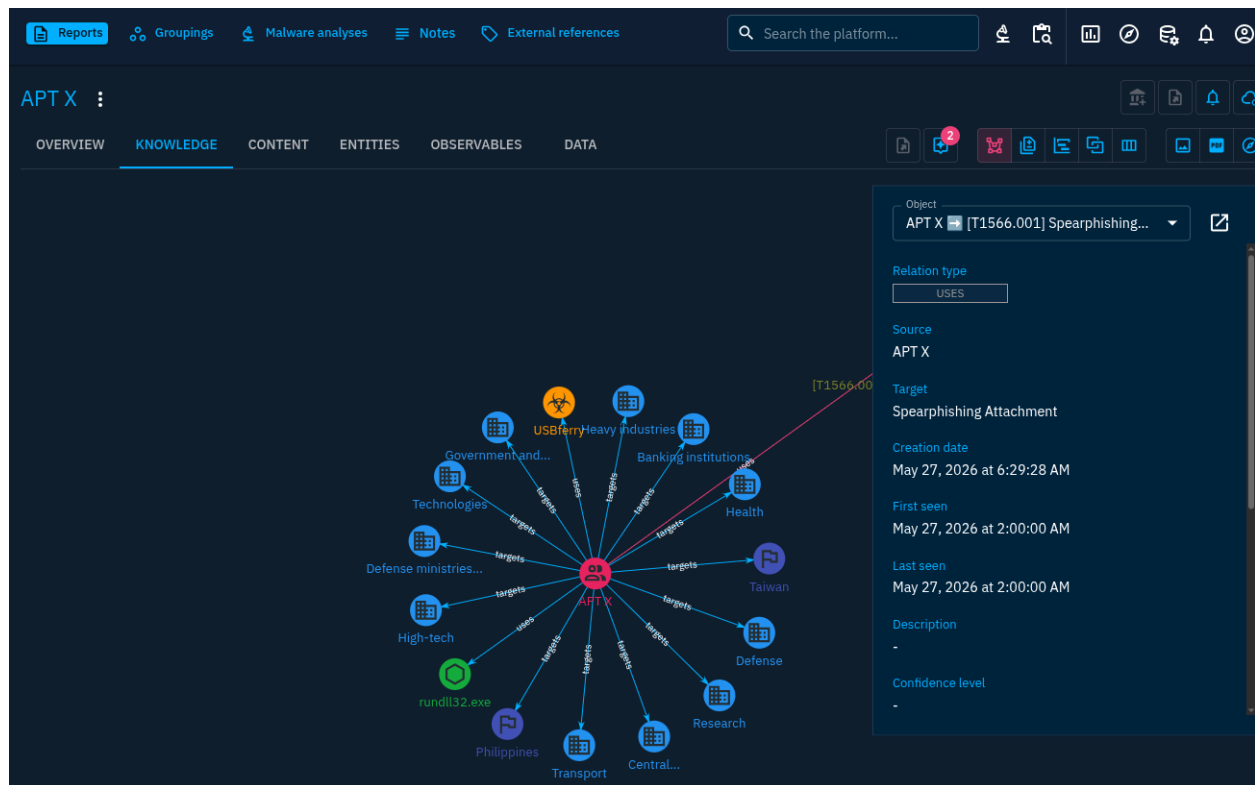


Answer the questions below

What is the name of the phishing sub-technique used by APT X for initial access?

Spearphishing Attachment

Open the APT X report, navigate to the knowledge, select external threat references



What is the name of the malware used by APT X?

USBferry

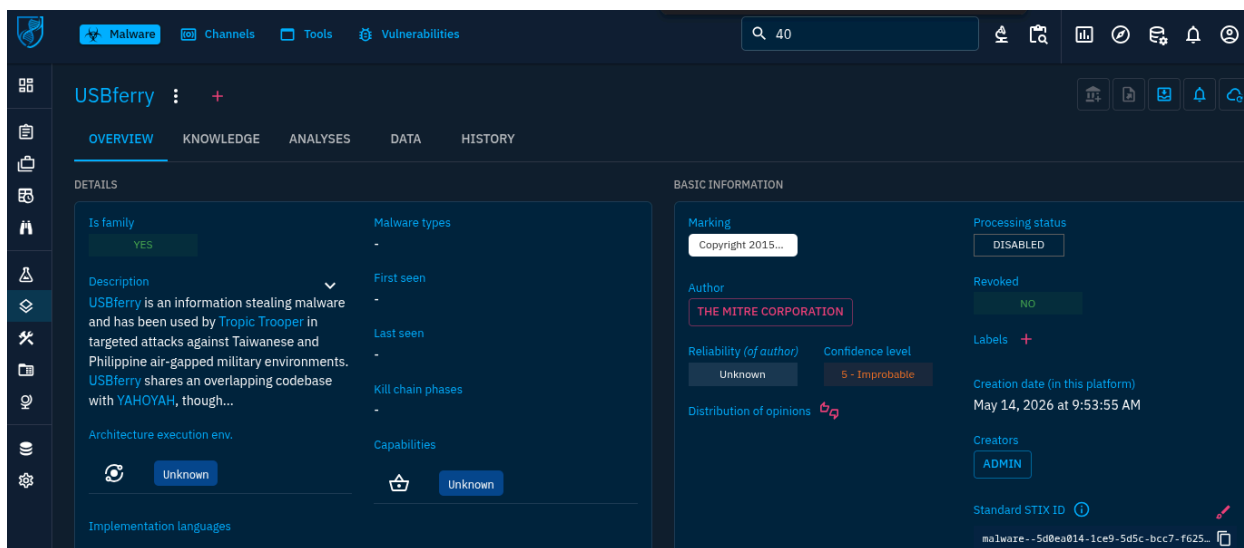
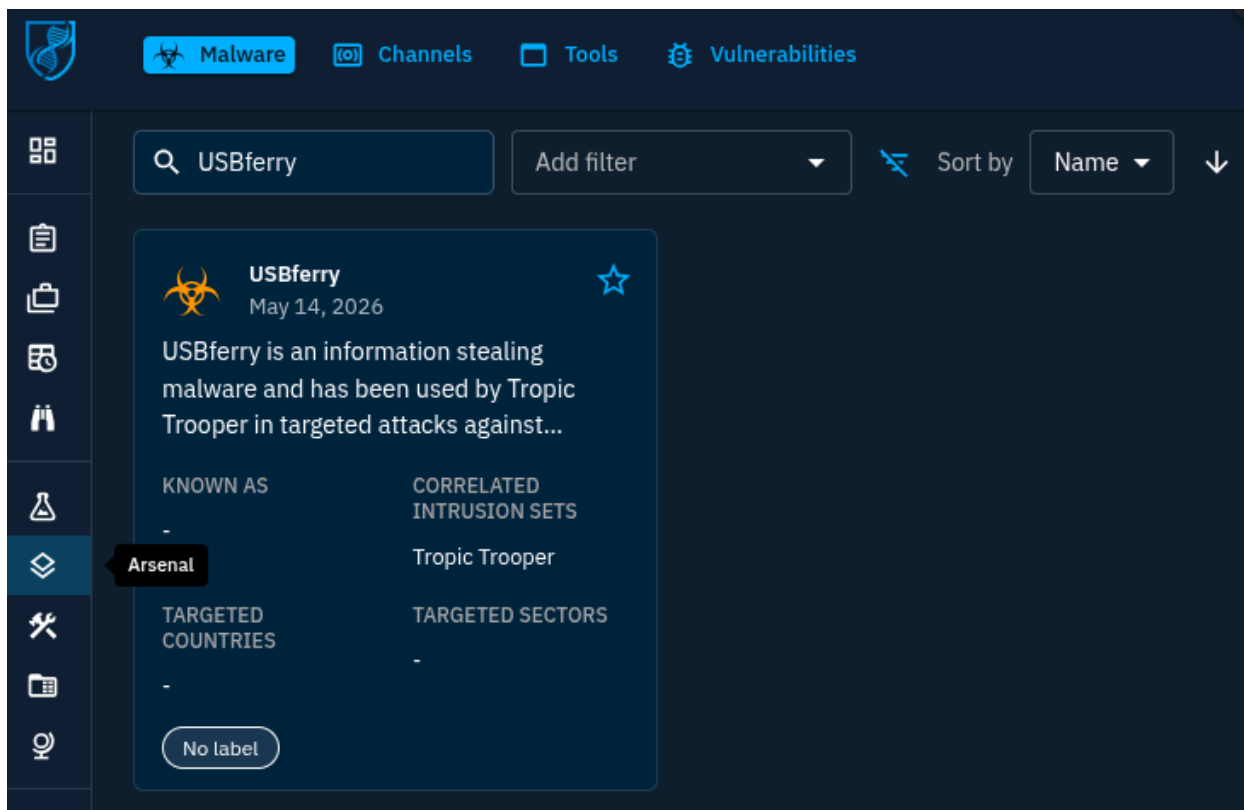
Go to the content, read the document

The screenshot displays the APT X knowledge base interface. The top navigation bar includes links for Reports, Groupings, Malware analyses, Notes, and External references, along with a search bar. The main content area is titled 'APT X' and features a navigation menu with Overview, Knowledge, Content (selected), Entities, Observables, and Data. The 'Content' section shows a report titled 'surveillanceware.' with two columns of text. The left column discusses APT X's activities, mentioning USBferry attacks and the group's focus on stealing defense-, ocean-, and ship-related documents. The right column, titled 'Figure 1: A sample scenario of the USBferry attack', describes how APT X targets potentially unsecured organizations and uses USBferry malware to steal information. Below the text, there is a section titled 'A USB malware called USBferry' which mentions a PricewaterhouseCoopers report and the discovery of multiple versions of the malware.

What is the malware's STIX ID?

malware--5d0ea014-1ce9-5d5c-bcc7-f625a07907d0

Go to the arsenal section, select USBferry, click to view the details



Using the knowledge available for the above malware, what is the true identity of APT X?

Tropic Trooper

Go to the entities section, search for malware, and select USBFerry.

APT X

OVERVIEW KNOWLEDGE CONTENT ENTITIES OBSERVABLES DATA

malware Add filter 3 entitie(s)

	TYPE	NAME	LABELS	AUTHOR	CREATION ...	ANALYSES	MARKING
☐	MALWARE	USBferry	No label	The MITRE Co...	May 14, 20...	1	Copyri...
☐	ATTACK PA...	[T1566.001] Spearphishing Attachment	No label	The MITRE Co...	May 14, 20...	1	Copyri...
☐	THREAT A...	APT X	No label	admin	May 27, 20...	1	NONE

USBferry

OVERVIEW KNOWLEDGE ANALYSES DATA HISTORY

DETAILS BASIC INFORMATION

Is family: YES

Description: USBferry is an information stealing malware and has been used by Tropic Trooper in targeted attacks against Taiwanese and Philippine air-gapped military environments. USBferry shares an overlapping codebase with YAHOOAH, though...

Architecture execution env.: Unknown

Implementation languages: Unknown

Malware types: -

First seen: -

Last seen: -

Kill chain phases: -

Capabilities: Unknown

Marking: Copyright 2015...

Processing status: DISABLED

Author: THE MITRE CORPORATION

Reliability (of author): Unknown

Confidence level: 5 - Improbable

Distribution of opinions: 0/0

Creation date (in this platform): May 14, 2026 at 9:53:55 AM

Creators: ADMIN

Standard STIX ID: malware - 5d0ea014-1ce9-5d5c-bcc7-f625...

Creation date: May 20, 2020 at 10:54:06 PM

Modification date: May 14, 2026 at 9:53:55 AM

How many attack patterns are associated with the target APT?

40

Online check How many attack patterns are associated with the target APT Tropic Trooper ? or Open the Knowledge tab for the intrusion set (APT X / Tropic Trooper). Look at the Distribution of relations or navigate to the Arsenal > Attack Patterns section.

Which Microsoft Exchange RCE vulnerability has the attacker been witnessed using?

CVE-2021-34473

Open the Entity, Click on Intrusion sets, Click on the Knowledge tab located, Check the Arsenal Section

What is the name of the command-line tool linked to the APT?

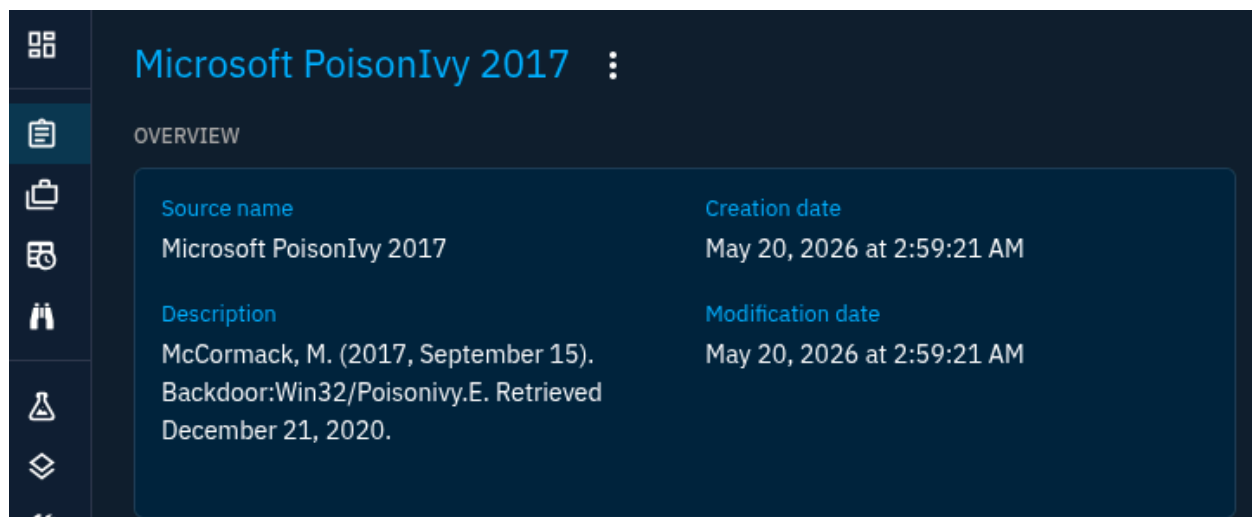
BITSAdmin

Navigate to the left-hand navigation pane, click on the Arsenal category, and select Tools to view the linked command-line utility.

What malware is the APT known to use for remote access?

PoisonIvy

Navigate to the Knowledge tab of the intrusion set/threat actor entity. Look under the Arsenal category in the left-hand navigation pane and click on Malware



What registry key has the APT created to establish persistence on target systems?

HKCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion\Winlogon\Shell

Navigate to the Reports section via the top navigation bar to read analytical reports detailing registry modifications, or use the Observations section on the left sidebar to view host-based artifacts.

During the stealth stage, which image file format does the group use to mask their backdoor activities?

JPG

check the MITRE ATT&CK-mapped techniques linked to the group under Techniques > Attack patterns, specifically looking for sub-techniques under Obfuscated Files or Information (Steganography / T1027.003)